Koala numbers

Word bank

stripped
koalas
falling
adult
tourists
Australia
predators
fur
ecosystem
conservationists
population
cars
numbers
habitats
conserve

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the passage below.

Koalas are cute and t_____ love them. But almost a century ago they were hunted for their f_____. In the 1920s the South Australian government tried to c_____ koala numbers by introducing 18 adult k_____ to Kangaroo Island. Because there were no p_____, and they were not being hunted, the koala population increased steadily. In 2001 koala n_____ on the island were estimated at 27 000. There were so many koalas that they s_____ and eventually killed the manna gum trees they lived on, damaging the **e**_____ of the island. In response, the government started **de-sexing** some a_____ koalas and removing others to the mainland.

Elsewhere in A_____, koala numbers are f_____ as the koalas are threatened by logging, foxes, dogs, c_____ and **urbanisation**. Some c_____ are against the mainland resettlement program. They believe that adding more koalas puts pressure on the shrinking mainland h_____. They also believe that random de-sexing can limit the **gene pool** in the already in-bred p_____ of Kangaroo Island.

2 Use the information above to plot a graph showing the increase in the koala population on Kangaroo Island from the 1920s to 2001.



3 According to the graph, how many koalas do you think there would be in 2030 if numbers weren't controlled? _____

4 Do you think this modelling would be accurate? Why/why not? _____

_____

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ISBN 978 1 92571 041 0